

with it increased speed, better support for networking with Windows-based PCs, iChat (an AOL IM client), a spam filter and more.

November 7: XP for the TabletPC

Microsoft released the TabletPC Edition of their popular Windows XP Professional OS. This is greeted with wide acclaim, as experts believe that the future of portable computing lies in TabletPCs. Research firms do studies, predict that by 2007, 20 per cent of all laptops sold will be TabletPCs. They're proved wrong as the TabletPC remains an attractive option for only a niche user group. Most end-users opt for cheaper and simpler notebook computers—quite happy with the lack of a stylus and making do with the good old touchpad-and-keyboard system.

December 19: DirectX 9.0—the big leap

Microsoft released DirectX 9.0, a step up from the DirectX 8.x series. The new suite of Microsoft's multimedia APIs enhanced the efficiency of the OS to communicate with games, hardware and drivers and produce better-looking visuals on-screen. DX 9 included a lot of security fixes and technology upgrades, and needed compatible hardware to run it. Graphics card manufacturers soon released drivers for existing cards and new hardware that could make use of the new API suite.

2003

The Birth Of MySpace And Mozilla

March 28: Windows Server 2003

Microsoft announced the release of Windows Server 2003. The new server OS promised up to a 30 per cent increase in efficiency and double the speeds. This server OS was initially shipped in four different editions: Windows Server 2003: Standard, Enterprise, Datacenter and Web editions. In later years, the popularity of this server OS grew by leaps and bound to the point where it overtook Linux as the preferred OS for servers sometime in 2005.